



A PROXA LABS PERSPECTIVE FOR
COMMERCIAL LEARNING

Future- Proofing Your Organization

**AI readiness, and what you really
should be getting ready for**

by John Royer, Founder • Proxa Labs

Most commercial learning teams are preparing for the wrong thing. Literacy, governance, and compliance are the floor of the building. This paper is about the question almost no one is asking: ready for what?

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The floor is not the finish line

Most commercial learning teams in life sciences are preparing for the wrong thing. They have heard that AI readiness means three things: literacy, governance, and compliance. They are building those and they are right to. But those three are the floor of the building, and right now the entire industry is mistaking the floor for the finish line.

The harder question, the one almost no one is being asked, is this: What are we getting ready for? You can certify every person on your team, stand up a governance committee, and set a clear compliance path, and still be completely unprepared for the way work is about to change. Within a planning cycle or two, the teams that win will not be running AI pilots on the side. They will be generating content, building processes, and personalizing learning at a speed and scale that makes the current operating model look like a fax machine.

This is not a warning to move faster. It is a different way of thinking about what readiness is for. The teams that treat AI as a project will keep producing failed pilots. The teams that weave it into the fabric of how they work every day will end up leading.

For the head of sales training or enablement, that is the opening of a career. For years your function has been the afterthought to the brand team and its agency. The shift underway is the first real chance to change that.

This perspective lays out the three foundations everyone is talking about, what they are actually preparing you for, why most efforts stall, and a practical order of operations for getting ready for what is coming. It ends where the next conversation begins.

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The AI-readiness everyone means

Walk into any pharma learning conference this year and ask the room a simple question. How many of you believe AI readiness means having a use case, a governance model, and a compliance process? Most hands go up. Those people are not wrong. They are just early, and they think they are late.

Three foundations come up in every serious conversation about getting an organization ready. They are real, and they are non-negotiable. The problem is that each one is widely misunderstood, and the misunderstanding is what keeps teams stuck at the starting line while believing they have crossed it.

01

Literacy is not familiarity

The most common version of AI literacy in life sciences is a team that knows how to use Copilot to clean up a slide. That is a start, and nowhere near enough. In one session with 37 learning leaders from across the industry, not one had heard of NotebookLM, a tool that turns a stack of documents into a narrated audio briefing in ninety seconds. Literacy is not whether your people can use a tool they already know. It is the instinct to ask whether AI should do part of a task, and to know which part. That instinct is teachable, and almost no one is teaching it.

02

Governance is not a committee

Most governance efforts produce a steering group, a policy document, and a sense of relief. What they rarely produce is a set of guardrails specific enough that a content developer knows, on a Tuesday afternoon, what they are allowed to build with AI and what they are not. Governance that lives in a binder protects no one. Governance that lives in the daily workflow is the only kind that lets people move quickly without putting the company at risk.

03

Compliance is not a gate at the end

In a regulated industry, the instinct is to treat compliance as the final checkpoint where AI work goes to be approved or killed. That guarantees one of two outcomes: nothing gets out the door, or compliance gets sidestepped and the organization carries risk it cannot see. The teams getting this right design compliance in as a constraint from the first keystroke, so that what gets built is already inside the lines. In pharma, this is the thing that decides whether AI content development is possible at all.

Get these three locked down and you've built the foundation.

What are you getting ready for?

Here is the question worth being a little difficult about. If you have your literacy, your governance, and your compliance, what exactly are you ready to do?

The honest answer for most teams is “run a pilot.” And that is the tell. If you’re getting ready for a pilot, you’re getting ready for nothing. The thing you should be getting ready for is far bigger, and it is already visible if you know where to look.

Here’s what you’re actually getting ready for:

AI-generated content development

Where a launch curriculum that used to take a quarter now takes a few weeks, and the bottleneck moves from production to judgment.

AI-generated process development

Where the work of designing a national sales meeting or an onboarding program starts with an agent and a prompt rather than a blank deck.

Personalized learning

Delivery that adapts to each rep in real time, the promise the field has made for twenty years and never met.

Self-serve creation

Where the people closest to the content build it themselves instead of waiting in the agency’s queue.

This raises a question the most sophisticated buyers are already asking out loud: what kind of roles will this infrastructure create? The answer is that you will need new ones, and the organizations that define them before their competitors will spend the next five years hiring from a position of strength instead of scrambling.

By 1997 the internet had clear players, real e-commerce, and established winners. In 1994 nobody knew who was doing what, and the companies that planted a flag first mostly got run over by the ones who learned from their mistakes. What matters is that the work is about to change completely, the change cannot be stopped, and the only real choice is whether you shape your team for it deliberately or get reshaped by it.

For a sense of scale, look outside pharma. Walmart has said it intends to put its entire associate base, more than two million people, through structured AI training. When the largest private employer in the country decides AI fluency is table stakes for every job, the question for a commercial learning team is not whether this is coming. It is whether you would rather lead it or be assigned it.

Why the pilots die

Almost everyone reading this has sat in a room and watched a hand go up to the question: how many of you have had an AI pilot that went nowhere? The more interesting question is why.

Fact: pilots do not die due to bad technology; they die because no one pulls the technology through the fabric of how the team actually works. A pilot is a separate room in the building. People walk into it, do something impressive, walk back out, and return to the way they have always worked. The pilot was never connected to anything real, so when the novelty fades there are no new behaviors holding it in place.

Think about how a car fits into your life. You do not run a car pilot. You do not use it once to get groceries and then leave it in the garage as a proof of concept. It is woven into how you move through the day, so completely that you stop noticing it. That is the bar for AI inside an organization. The goal is not adoption rates or use-case counts. The goal is the moment when a content developer's first instinct, when they need to build something, is to open the AI tool, because that is simply how the work is done now.

This is also where the failed pilot becomes expensive in a way that does not show up on a dashboard. Every pilot that fails teaches the organization that AI is hype, that the last person who pushed it overpromised, and that the safe move is to wait. The teams that have run three dead pilots are often less ready than the teams that have run none, because they have trained their own people to be skeptical. Readiness is more than capability. It is whether the organization believes the change is real and is built to absorb it.

Here is the part that should get your attention. The thesis itself is not controversial. Ask anyone working seriously on AI, whether inside the most advanced consulting practices or inside the few teams that have made it stick, and they will tell you the same thing in one line: the entire game is how deeply you weave AI into the fabric of the work. That sentence gets nodded at in every keynote. Then everyone walks out and goes back to running pilots in the side room. That gap, between what the industry agrees on and what it actually practices, is the largest unclaimed opportunity in commercial learning today. Closing it has little to do with team size or budget. It takes one thing: a team willing to stop treating AI as a project and start treating it as how the work gets done.

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The mobilization plan

None of this information is useful if there's no plan of action. The reason the three foundations matter is that they are the precondition for everything that comes after, and they have to come in order. Here is the sequence as it actually works.

01

Literacy

First, literacy, because nothing downstream functions without people who can do the work. Not familiarity with one tool, but the trained instinct to look at a task and route the right part of it to AI. This is the slowest of the three to build and the one most teams skip, because it is easier to buy a platform than to change how people think. Skip it and every later step runs on a foundation of people who cannot tell good output from bad.

02

Governance

The moment people can build quickly, the organization needs guardrails that let them move without creating risk. The test is whether a developer knows what they can build today without asking, and what they must escalate. Governance that answers that in the flow of work is an accelerator. Governance that does not is a brake.

03

Compliance

Designed in rather than bolted on, so the work produced is already inside the regulatory lines. In a regulated industry this is the step that decides whether AI content development is viable at all. Get it right and you build at speed with confidence. Get it wrong and you choose between paralysis and exposure.

Only when those three are locked down is an organization actually ready to do the thing it has been preparing for: generate content, build processes, and personalize learning as a matter of routine. That is the execution layer, and it is where the value finally shows up in terms a chief commercial officer cares about. A launch curriculum in six weeks instead of three months. A national sales meeting where the prep work starts with "build me the plan" and ends with a human refining it, instead of a team scrambling for a month. Faster, better content and faster, better processes, produced by the function that knows the material better than any agency ever will.

If you run sales training or enablement, this is the line to sit with. Today the brand team and its agency own the launch and the national sales meeting, and your function lives on the scraps. Capability was never the problem. They had two things you did not: the tools and the mandate. The tools are about to belong to everyone. The team that picks them up first, and knows the content cold, has a real claim to lead the work it has spent years merely supporting. People throw around "this could be learning's time" as a feel-good line at conferences. Read it instead as a forecast: the most valuable work in the commercial organization is about to change hands, and the function that moves first will be the one holding it.

The end of the beginning

All the concepts and positions presented in this paper are the tip of the spear: the three foundations, the new roles, the order of operations. That is what it takes to get ready. But getting ready is just the beginning. The organizations that truly future proof themselves will keep going long after the rest have declared victory at compliance, and what they build next is a different conversation entirely.

A closing thought on where AI is heading, and why it shapes the choices you make now. When the work becomes generating, delivering, and personalizing learning at scale, the last thing a regulated organization wants is a dozen disconnected tools, each needing its own IT approval, its own security review, its own integration. The teams that move fastest will consolidate that work into a single closed loop, where content is built, delivered, personalized, and validated in one place, with compliance designed into every step. That is the architecture the next phase rewards, and it is worth keeping in view even while you are still laying the foundation.

If the question “ready for what?” lands, that is the right reaction. It is the question almost no one in this industry is asking, and the teams that ask it first are the ones who will not be caught flat-footed by what comes next. We would welcome the conversation about what your answer should be.

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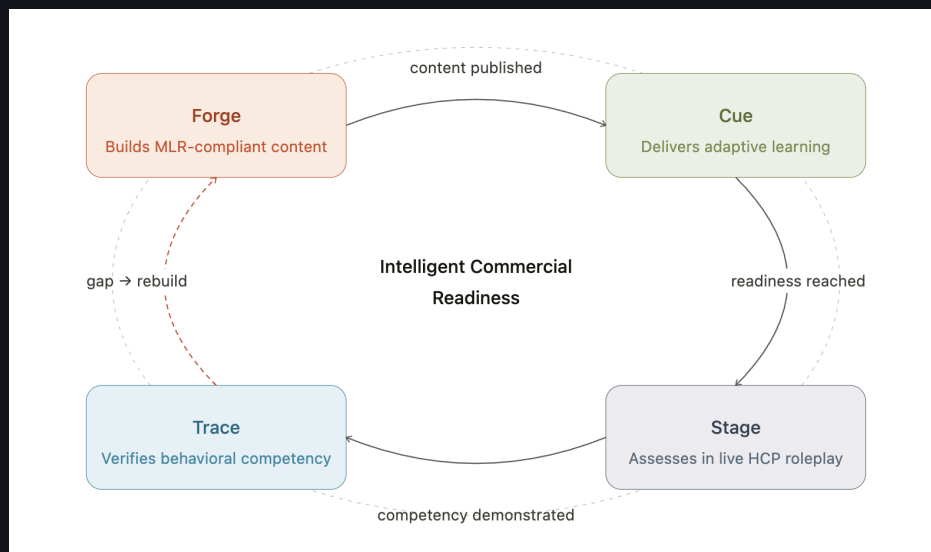
About Proxa Labs

Proxa Labs is an AI-native company, built from what AI makes possible in commercial learning. We originated from inside biopharma, so regulatory constraints are part of the platform's design from the start. The three foundations this paper began with are our starting point: compliance, governance, and literacy, treated as design constraints from the first line of code rather than retrofits.

That philosophy is why we built a closed loop instead of another point tool. Content is created, delivered, personalized, and validated in one place, with compliance designed into every step and private models that keep proprietary data off public APIs. Reps practice in realistic AI role-plays and earn certification on the same platform that builds their learning paths, while an adaptive tutor closes the gaps that practice exposes. For a regulated organization, the payoff is concrete: one system to secure, one integration to approve, and a single record of who is certified on what when an auditor asks.

"We should do something about AI" is where most teams start and stall. We'll show your team where its literacy, governance, and compliance stand today, and the shortest path to getting ready for what's coming.

Intelligent Commercial Readiness





Ready to do something about AI?

We will show your team where its literacy, governance, and compliance stand today, and the shortest path to getting ready for what is coming.

[START THE CONVERSATION](#)